Donation Refund Policy

Waves For Water Philippines

1. Purpose

This Donation Refund Policy sets out the circumstances under which **Waves for Water Organization, Inc.** doing business as **Waves For Water Philippines** ("Waves For Water," the "Organization," "we," "us," or "our") may refund monetary donations, and the procedure for requesting a refund. It applies to all donations made through our website, our authorized payment channels, and third-party payment platforms engaged by the Organization, including Xendit.

This Donation Refund Policy forms an integral part of our Donation Terms and Conditions.

Personal information submitted in connection with a refund request will be processed in accordance with our Privacy Policy and the Data Privacy Act of 2012. **2. General Rule: Donations Are Final**

Donations are voluntary, gratuitous contributions under Philippine law. Once a donation has been successfully completed and confirmed by the authorized payment provider, it is generally final and non-refundable.

Funds received are promptly committed to the Organization's programs, including clean water access, WASH interventions, and disaster response initiatives, and to the operational costs necessary to sustain them. This ensures responsible stewardship of charitable funds, and compliance with humanitarian standards.

3. Exceptions: When a Refund May Be Granted

As a matter of good faith and donor care and compliance with payment industry standards, the Organization may, upon verification, grant a refund in the following limited and exceptional circumstances:

- **Duplicate transaction.** The same donation was inadvertently charged more than once due to a system, network, or user error.
- **Erroneous amount.** The donor entered an incorrect amount (for example, an obvious typographical error such as PHP 50,000 instead of PHP 500). In such cases, the Organization may refund the difference or the full amount, at the donor's option.

- **Unauthorized transaction.** The donation was made without the authority of the lawful holder of the card, account, or e-wallet used, such as in cases of fraud or identity theft, subject to verification and coordination with the payment provider and the issuing bank.
- **Technical error.** A demonstrable technical fault on the part of the Organization's donation page or its payment platform resulted in an incorrect charge.
- **Recurring donation charged after valid cancellation.** A recurring donation was charged after the donor's cancellation request had taken effect.

Refunds are not available for a mere change of mind, dissatisfaction with the Organization's programs or communications, or the donor's failure to cancel a recurring donation before the billing date, or requests that cannot be verified or appear fraudulent or abusive..

4. Period for Requesting a Refund

Refund requests must be submitted within fifteen (15) calendar days from the date of the transaction, except for unauthorized transactions, which should be reported as soon as the donor becomes aware of them (and, in any case, within the dispute period allowed by the donor's bank or card issuer). Requests submitted beyond these periods will be assessed on a case-by-case basis and may not be granted.

5. How to Request a Refund

To request a refund, the donor (or the lawful holder of the payment instrument) should email us at philippines@wavesforwater.org with the subject line "Donation Refund Request," providing:

- Full name and contact details of the donor;
- Date and amount of the donation;
- Payment method used and transaction or reference number (as shown in the Xendit or payment confirmation);
- Reason for the refund request; and
- Supporting documents where applicable (e.g., proof of duplicate charges, bank or card statement excerpts, or a report of unauthorized use).

6. Verification and Processing

- The Organization will acknowledge refund requests within three (3) business days of receipt and will verify the request with its records and, where necessary, with Xendit or the relevant payment provider or bank.
- Approved refunds will ordinarily be processed within seven (7) to fifteen (15) business days from approval, through the original payment method used, via the payment provider..
- The time for the refunded amount to reflect in the donor's account depends on the donor's bank, card issuer, or e-wallet provider and may take additional banking days beyond our processing period.
- Refunds are issued in Philippine Pesos (or the original transaction currency, where applicable). The Organization is not responsible for foreign exchange differences, or for bank or gateway fees that are non-recoverable from third parties; such fees may be deducted from the refunded amount where they cannot be recovered.
- Cross-border refunds may involve additional verification, intermediary bank fees, foreign exchange conversion, and processing delays beyond the Organization’s control
- The Organization reserves the right to decline a refund request where the claimed circumstances cannot be verified, where the request appears fraudulent or abusive, or where a refund would contravene applicable law, including anti-money laundering regulations. Refunds will be made only to the original payment source and never to a different account, consistent with anti-money laundering safeguards.
- Refund requests may be subject to identity verification, sanctions screening, and AML/CTF checks. The Organization may decline or report refund requests that appear suspicious or inconsistent with applicable AML/CTF laws.

7. Unauthorized Transactions and Chargebacks

- Donors who suspect unauthorized use of their card, account, or e-wallet should notify both the Organization and their issuing bank or e-wallet provider immediately. The Organization will cooperate with the payment provider and the bank in investigating and resolving verified unauthorized transactions.

- We encourage donors to contact the Organization first before initiating a chargeback, as most concerns can be resolved directly and more quickly. The Organization will honor chargeback outcomes determined through the payment networks' dispute processes.

8. Effect on Receipts and Tax Documents

Where a donation is refunded in full or in part, any official receipt, acknowledgment, or Certificate of Donation (BIR Form 2322) previously issued for that donation shall be cancelled or amended accordingly, and the donor shall not use such documents to claim any tax benefit with respect to the refunded amount.

9. Recurring Donations

Cancellation of a recurring donation takes effect prospectively and stops future charges. Amounts already charged prior to the effectivity of a cancellation are refundable only under the circumstances described in Section 3 of this Policy. Donors may cancel by contacting [Insert Email Address] or through the facility provided on the payment platform.

10. Amendments

The Organization may revise this Policy from time to time. The updated version will be posted on our website and donation channels with a revised effective date and will apply to refund requests made after posting.

11. Governing Law and Dispute Resolution

This Policy is governed by the laws of the Republic of the Philippines and shall observe the rules on dispute resolution as provided under the Donation Terms and Conditions.